7. Acting as a link between management and staff.

Maintaining public relations (i.e.) informing the public about the activities of the organization.

The role of the secretary is to support the chairman in ensuring the smooth functioning of the managing committee. In summary, the secretary is responsible for proper meetings, preparing minutes of the meetings, and maintaining effective records and administration.

Do You Know?

In 1952, Mary Barrett, president of the National Secretaries Association, C. King Woodbridge, president of Dictaphone Corporation, and American businessman Harry F. Klemfuss created a special Secretary's Day holiday, to recognize the hard work of the staff in the office. The holiday caught on, and during the fourth week of April is now celebrated in offices all over the world. It has been renamed "Administrative Professional's Week" to highlight the increased responsibility of today's secretary and other administrative workers, and to avoid embarrassment to those who believe that "secretary" refers only to women or to unskilled workers.

8.3. General Qualification of the Secretaries:

Since secretaries may be required to perform a wide range of functions, they should possess necessary qualification to discharge their duties properly, which includes:

i. **Sound General Education:** Every secretary should have a sound general education. A university degree is considered as a desirable academic qualification and a High school certificate is the minimum education required.

ii. **Proficiency in Language:** To be a successful secretary he should have good communication skill. He should have good command over English language and should possess sufficient skills in writing business letters, drafting reports, preparing notes, agenda, minutes of the meetings, etc.,

iii. **Wide General Knowledge:** A secretary must have general knowledge to handle the emergency situation without delay. It also helps him to understand the instruction given by his employer without delay.

iv. **Knowledge of Office Organization and Methods:** Secretary is considered as an administrative head of secretarial department. He should know to organize the activities of his department and also be familiar with the procedures to carry out the activities.

v. **Knowledge of General Procedure of Meetings:** He has to make arrangements for meetings, help the chairman in conducting meetings and record the proceedings of meeting, so the secretary must know the general procedure to be followed in connection with meetings.

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